Cum in superiore Consistorio

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EPISTOLAE .

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AD EMUM P. D. IOANNEM, TITULO S. MARIAE TRANS TIBERIM, S. R. E. PRESB.

CARD. TACCI, S A C R I CONSILII PRO ECCLESIA ORIENTALI SECRETARIUM:

DE APPARANDIS SOLLEMNIBUS IN SEXTUM DECIMUM PLENUM SAECULUM A

CONCILIO NICAENO.

D i l e c t e fili N o s t e r , s a l u t e m et a p o s t o l i c a m b e n e d i c t i o n e m . — Cum in s u - periore Consistorio, u t aiunt, secreto, P u r p u r a t i s P a t r i b u s n u n t i a v i m u s m e n - t e m esse N o s t r a m , u t s e x t u m d e c i m u m p l e n u m s a e c u l u m a c o n v o c a t a abso- l u t a q u e N i c a e n a S y n o d o , e x Oecumenicis prima, i n b a c A l m a U r b e et sub oculis p a e n e N o s t r i s sollemniter recoleretur, a d d i d i m u s praeterea, proprias h a c d e r e Litteras N o s tibi inscripturos; a e q u u m e n i m N o b i s v i d e b a t u r , i n s t i t u e n d a e o r d i n a n d a e q u e eius e v e n t i c o m m e m o r a t i o n i s , q u o d i n E c c l e - siae catholicae fastis t a m elucet q u a m q u o d m a x i m e , m a n d a t u m tibi dari, u t p o t e qui Orientalis Ecclesiae n e g o t i a et a u c t o r i t a t e geras N o s t r a et, pro t u o religionis s t u d i o , s u m m o p e r e p r o v e h a s . E a q u i d e m res agitur, q u a e q u a n t i N o s t r a e t A p o s t o l i c a e Sedis intersit, o m n e s intellegunt, q u i c u m q u e res E c c l e s i a e g e s t a s v e l mediocriter t e n e n t . N a m , u t litterarum m o n u m e n t a testantur , Concilium N i c a e n u m p r i m u m , q u o d e o s p e c t a b a t u t Ariana haeresis prorogaretur, Ario i m p i i s q u e eius asseclis d a m n a n d i s , nisi resipuis- s e n t , d e q u e Ecclesiae gremio eiiciendis, c o a c t u m n o n e s t nisi d e c o n s e n s u Silvestri Pontificis e o d e m q u e per s u o s p r a e s e n t e L e g a t o s , qui A c t i s , u t i p s a Consistorii occasione d i x i m u s , primi o m n i u m - n i m i r u m q u o d P o n t i - ficis p e r s o n a m sustinerent - subscripsere, licet V i t u s ac V i n c e n t i u s sacer- d o t i o d u m t a x a t initiati essent. N e q u e o m i t t e n d u m , a n a t h e m a in Arianes s a n c t a e E c c l e s i a e Catholicae et A p o s t o l i c a e n o m i n e l a t u m a P a t r i b u s esse, e t A p o s t o l i c a m S e d e m doctrinae Nicaenae capita tamquam sua et a se p r o b a t a h a b u i s s e ac défendisse. M u l t a ceteroquin alia, q u a e ad fidem et ad disciplinam pertinerent, saluberrime N i c a e n a S y n o d u s s a n x i t ac decrevit: u t d e P a s c h a t e u n o e o d e m q u e die u b i q u e celebrando, u t d e Meletiano schi- s m a t e d e q u e sectis N o v a t i a n i e t P a u l i S a m o s a t e n s i s , u t d e episcopis eligendis a c consecrandus, u t d e publicae p a e n i t e n t i a e in s t i t u t o , d e c a t e c h u m e n i s , d e i n i u s t o foenore; q u a e q u i d e m decreta a d f o v e n d a m E c c l e s i a e u n i t a t e m et disciplinam cleri p o p u l i q u e s t a b i l i e n d a m q u a m p l u r i m u m profuerunt. I a m - v e r o inlustrari h a e c o m n i a et v u l g o patefieri oportere, u t Christo D o m i n o et

P e t r i Cathedrae d e b i t u s honor et d e b i t a gratia h a b e a t u r , dilecte f i l i N o s t e r , est N o b i s persuasissimum: in q u o propterea, q u a soles sollertia, elaborare ne d u b i t e s . A c c i t i s igitur egregiis viris, qui E c c l e s i a e in u n i v e r s u m r e r u m q u e praecipue Orientalium calleant historiam, i i s d e m q u e in c o n s i l i u m adhibitis, v i d e a s q u o p a c t o s a e c u l a r e m e i u s m o d i f a u s t i t a t e m celebrari liceat: e x iis a u t e m , qui h a r u m c o g n i t i o n e rerum et dicendi f a c u l t a t e p r a e s t a n t , n o n n u l - los eligito, qui e v e n t u m s a n e celeberrimum per scripta l a t e d i v u l g a n d a ©rationesque p u b l i c e h a b e n d a s in s u a luce collocent. Q u a e u t i n a m c o m m e - m o r a t i o nonnihil a d i d conferat, q u o d t a m v e h e m e n t e r cupimus, n e m p e ut Orientales populi, quos a R o m a n a E c c l e s i a m i s e r r i m u m a d h u c disci- d i u m transversos agit, c o m m u n i o n e m N o b i s c u m f i d e i , praeiudicatis opinio- n i b u s depositis, desiderent a t q u e h a u d n e q u i q u a m desiderent. U t a u t e m m u n u s a N o b i s t i b i c o m m i s s u m facilius e x p l e a s , efficiat apostolica benedi- ctio, q u a m , c a e l e s t i u m a u s p i c e m l u m i n u m fraternaeque caritatis N o s t r a e t e s t e m , tibi, dilecte fili N o s t e r , iisque o m n i b u s , quos tui laboris socios adsciveris, p e r a m a n t e r in D o m i n o i m p e r t i m u s . Datum Romae a p u d S a n c t u m P e t r u m , die i v mensis aprilis, anno M D C C C C X X V , Pontificatus Nostri quarto.

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